

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Landslide & debris flow

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Move away from a slide area if you can do so safely, and obey evacuation warnings. Avoid steep slopes, channels and places downhill from recent burns during heavy rain. Do not cross moving debris or enter a fresh slide to inspect it.

Do now.

- ☐ **Notice warning signs**
01 New ground cracks, tilting trees, unusual runoff or rumbling warrant immediate caution and a call to local authorities.
- ☐ **Leave the affected area**
02 Use an official safe route rather than following a drainage channel.
- ☐ **Avoid crossings**
03 Mud and debris can sweep away vehicles and hide damaged road surfaces.
- ☐ **Report from safety**
04 Give the location and visible hazards to emergency services; keep others out.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Stay away from channels, fresh debris and unstable slopes after the first movement. Do not cross the slide to check a house or search for belongings. Choose a destination outside the runout area rather than simply a higher point on the same unstable slope.

Watch for.

Another slide can follow the first, especially during continued rain.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Return only after local authorities assess stability. Contact a qualified professional about slope or structural damage.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

[Landslide & debris flow · official guidance](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/landslide/>